

Robert J. Carroll

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Appointments

- 2019– *Assistant Professor of Political Science*, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
2015–2019 *Assistant Professor of Political Science*, Florida State University
2014–2015 *Visiting Fellow*, Kroc Institute for International Peace Studies, University of Notre Dame

Education

- 2015 PhD in Political Science, University of Rochester
2014 MA in Political Science, University of Rochester
2009 MA in Political Science, Michigan State University
2007 BA in Government, University of Louisiana at Monroe

Publications

- 2026 **Robert J. Carroll**, David M. Konisky, and Christopher Reenock. "Policy Devolution and Cooperation Dilemmas." *Journal of Theoretical Politics* **38**(4): 257–286.
[DOI: 10.1177/09516298261454888](https://doi.org/10.1177/09516298261454888)
- 2024 Peter Bils, **Robert J. Carroll**, and Lawrence S. Rothenberg. "Strategic Avoidance and Rulemaking Procedures." *Journal of Theoretical Politics* **36**(2): 156–185.
[DOI: 10.1177/09516298241237209](https://doi.org/10.1177/09516298241237209)
- 2021 **Robert J. Carroll** and Amy Pond. "Costly Signaling in Autocracy." *International Interactions* **47**(4): 612–632.
[DOI: 10.1080/03050629.2021.1898956](https://doi.org/10.1080/03050629.2021.1898956)
- 2019 **Robert J. Carroll** and Brenton Kenkel. "Prediction, Proxies, and Power." *American Journal of Political Science* **63**(3): 577–593.
[DOI: 10.1111/ajps.12442](https://doi.org/10.1111/ajps.12442)
- 2016 **Robert J. Carroll**, David M. Primo, and Brian Kelleher Richter. "Using Item Response Theory to Improve Measurement in Strategic Management Research: An Application to Corporate Social Responsibility." *Strategic Management Journal* **37**(1): 66–85.
[DOI: 10.1002/smj.2463](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.2463)

Books under contract

Policy Spaces as Organizational Schemes

[*Cambridge Elements in Campaigns and Elections*]

The Shape of Possible States

[*Palgrave Macmillan*]

Work under review

Fighting in the Shadow of Intervention: A Learned-Proxy Analysis

[*conditionally accepted at Political Science Research & Methods*]

Causal Claims with Game-Theoretic Models

[*resubmitted to American Political Science Review*]

Preferring Unified Theories

Sunspot Volatility and the Price of Peace

A State Is Its Relations: The Yoneda Lemma and Relational Identity in IR

Other work in progress

A Theory of Force

[*book manuscript*]

War and Peace in the Marketplace

[*book manuscript*]

Borders, Spillovers, and the Watershed Lattice

with David M. Konisky and Christopher Reenock

Careers and Conflict in Revolutionary France

Honors and awards

2023–2024	James H. Kuklinski Award for Excellence in Graduate Mentoring, Department of Political Science, UIUC
2021–2022	Clarence A. Berdahl Award for Excellence in Undergraduate Teaching, ΠΣΑ, UIUC
2020–2021	Peter Nardulli Award for Research, UIUC
2020–2025	List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent by Their Students, UIUC
2020–2021	Dina Zinnes Graduate Teaching Award, Department of Political Science, UIUC
2020–2021	Impact Award, College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, UIUC
2015	First Year Assistant Professor Award, FSU
2014	Top 5 Paper, Annual Meeting of the Strategic Management Society

Invited talks

2024	Washington University in St. Louis
2023	Princeton University
2019	University of South Carolina
2013	University at Buffalo, SUNY

Courses taught

(G) graduate course

University of Illinois

Strategic International Relations
State Formation
Strategic Models
International Relations Seminar (G)
International Political Economy (G)
Game Theory I (G)
Game Theory II (G)
Mechanism Design (G)
Readings in the Political Economy of Authoritarian Regimes (G)
Readings in the Political Economy of International Environmental Institutions (G)

Florida State University

Civil Wars and Political Violence
Special Topics in War and Peace
Understanding Political Science Research
Politics and the Theory of Games
Theories of Conflict (G)
Probability and Statistics (G)
Game Theory (G)
Readings in the Political Economy of Human Capital (G)

Advising

Graduate students

Xiaoli Guo (FSU, defended April 2018)
Matt Hauenstein (FSU, defended July 2018)
Phil Henrickson (FSU, defended November 2018)
Jordan Holsinger (FSU, defended June 2021)
Hyun Joo Cho (UIUC, defended May 2022)
Miles Williams (UIUC, defended June 2022)
Tolgahan Dilgin (UIUC, defended July 2023)
Jinwon Lee (UIUC, defended May 2025)
Do Young Gong (UIUC, defended March 2026)
Paul Un (UIUC)
Myla Burton (UIUC)

Undergraduate theses supervised

2026–2027	Elaina Cardenas
2025–2026	Sam Crutcher
2025–2026	Savannah Smith
2023–2024	Ethan Cooper
2023–2024	Chenyu Jiang
2022–2023	Sotis Gouriotis
2020–2021	Chris Buckley
2017–2018	Zachary Shuman

Service

2026–2027	Curriculum Committee, Game Studies and Design Minor, UIUC
2026–2027	Advisory Committee, Department of Political Science, UIUC
2024	Section Organizer, International Conflict Processes, MPSA Annual Meeting
2023–2024	Graduate Affairs Committee, Department of Political Science, UIUC
2022–2023	Advisory Committee, Department of Political Science, UIUC
2020–2021	IR Search Committee, Department of Political Science, UIUC
2016–2017	Executive Committee, Department of Political Science, FSU
2016–2017	IR Search Committee, Department of Political Science, FSU

Refereeing

American Journal of Political Science, American Political Science Review, Comparative Political Studies, Conflict Management and Peace Science, International Studies Quarterly, Journal of Conflict Resolution, Journal of Global Security Studies, Journal of Peace Research, Journal of Politics, and Political Analysis

Last updated: September 24, 2026.